

Like with Firefox, you can get Opera to alert you when a Web site is attempting to set a cookie on your computer. You can do this by checking the “Ask me before accepting cookies” option in the Cookies tab. Once again, use this option if you are really fearful of being attacked.



Block pop-ups with Opera

8.2 Firewalls

A firewall is based on a security policy—which can be customised by the user—that permits or denies communications to and from your PC. The difference between a firewall and an anti-virus is that a firewall blocks access to your computer and the setting up programs there, while an anti-virus blocks different kinds of security threats like virus installations and other malicious content where the presence of physical outsider access is not necessary.

8.2.1 The whats, whys and hows

Basically, a firewall protects your computer from unwanted Internet traffic. It filters the information coming into your computer, and if the information does not pass through the filters, it is blocked from entering. There are essentially two types of firewalls—personal (software) and network (hardware). We are here only discussing personal (software) firewalls.

A personal firewall allows you to request whatever you like from the Internet, but it blocks attempts to access files, applications, etc. on your computer. This is done in one of three different ways depending upon the firewall in use:

- Packet filtering, wherein packets (small chunks of data) are put through your firewall's filters. The filters decide whether the packets are to be accepted or not.